

Investigation Log

Case Information

Case ID: 2025-09-10-001

Date & Time: 2025-09-10, 11:00 – 13:00

Analyst: Oluwaniyi Damilare Enoch

Escalation Level: Tier 1 – Tier 2

Initial Alert

Time and date detected: 2025-09-10, 11:05

URL received: hxxps[://]sites[.]google[.]com/view/xksl/home

Suspicion: Possible phishing attempt.

Artifact 001:



Actions Taken

11:12 – First Analysis

Opened in URL2PNG

Artifact 002:



⦿

Homepage displayed **GMX branding** (possible impersonation).

Visible button text: *KLICKEN SIE HIER* (“Click Here” in German).

11: 20 - Page Content Analysis

Opened in Wanna Browser

Suspicious link extracted (from <a> tags)

Defanged Link:

hxxps[:]//www[.]google[.]com/url?q=hxxps%3A%2F%2Fwonderful-ganache-327ff8[.]netlify[.]app%2F&sa=D&sntz=1&usg=AOvVaw3TU1W7ZzQGpdsh2YKdStjv

11:40 – Redirect Chain Analysis

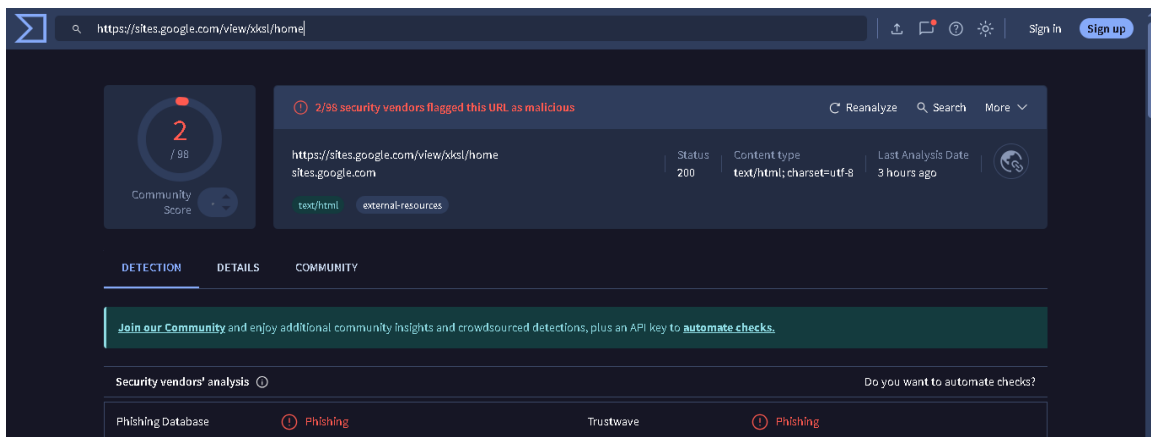
Observed 3 stages(all URLs were Defanged):

1. Initial page → hxxps[:]//sites[.]google[.]com/view/xksl/home
2. Redirect →
hxxps[:]//www[.]google[.]com/url?q=hxxps%3A%2F%2Fwonderful-ganache-327ff8[.]netlify[.]app%2F&sa=D&sntz=1&usg=AOvVaw3TU1W7ZzQGpdsh2YKdStjv
3. Final destination → hxxps[:]//wonderful-ganache-327ff8[.]netlify[.]app

11:50 – VirusTotal Analysis

1. hxxps[:]//sites[.]google[.]com/view/xksl/home → flagged (phishing).

Artifact 003:

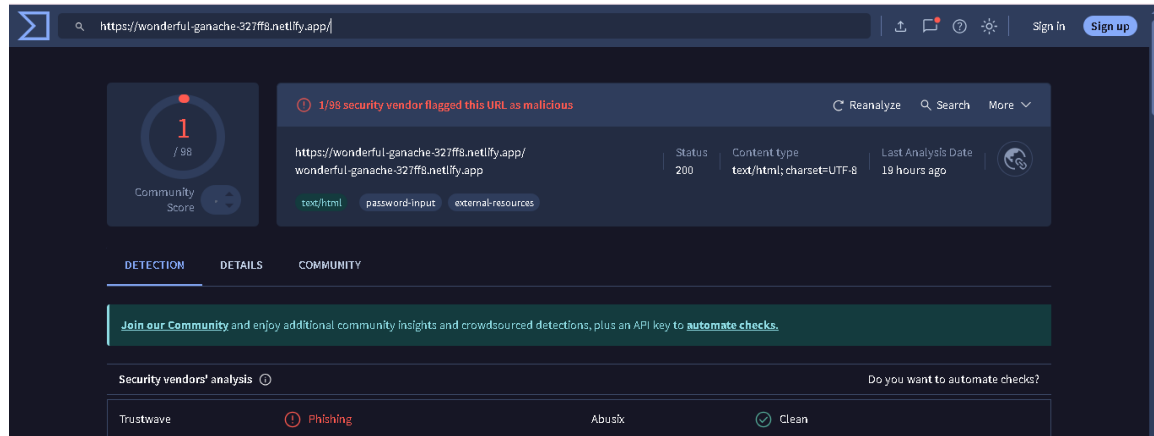


Body SHA-256:

5d0d18c0f01903de67441a0dbb5a366b9c66b949069a6789821827f340401d2
a

2. `hxxps[://]wonderful-ganache-327ff8[.]netlify[.]app` → flagged by multiple vendors as phishing.

Artifact 004:



Body SHA-256:

d62c53f8272758e99e35ca2e1c51b3cca79d9fdcaf60db16b6a15091de54e4da

12:05 – Background Behavior Concern

- Final page returned “Site not found” on Netlify.
- Possible that content was removed OR taken down after reporting.
- Cannot rule out hidden background requests (data exfil, beaconing).
- No active payload downloaded during test.

12:20 – Contextual Research

- GMX = two popular domains:
 - `gmx.com` (European email provider).
 - `gmx.io` (crypto exchange).
- Fake site may have attempted credential harvesting for either/both.

12:35 - MITRE ATT&CK Mapping

- Observed Technique(s):
 - T1566.002 – Phishing: Spearphishing via Link

- Potential/Intended Technique(s):
 - T1105 – Ingress Tool Transfer (if a payload were delivered)
- Follow-on Technique(s) (possible future use):
 - T1078 – Valid Accounts (if credentials harvested are later used)

13:00 – Escalation

- Recommended for Tier 2:
 - Run in sandbox with full network traffic capture.
 - Analyze for hidden background requests.
 - Attempt recovery of phishing form (if Netlify page restored).
- **Artifacts Submitted to Case Folder:**
 - Screenshots (Artifacts 001–004).
 - VirusTotal raw JSON reports for these two urls below are attached to the case folder:

hxxps[:]sites[.]google[.]com/view/xksl/home (virustotal_report.json)

hxxps[:]wonderful-ganache-327ff8[.]netlify[.]app
(virustotal_report1.json)

- HTML snippet extraction is attached below

```
<a class="FKF6mc TpQm9d QmpIrf"
href="hxxps[:]www[.]google[.]com/url?q=hxxps%3A%2F%2Fwonderful-
ganache-
327ff8[.]netlify[.]app%2F&sa=D&sntz=1&usg=AOvVaw3TU1W7ZzQGpd
sh2YKdStjv" target="_blank" aria-label="KLICKEN SIE HIER"><div
class="NsaAfc"><p>KLICKEN SIE HIER</p></div><div class="wvnY3c"
jsname="ksKsZd"></div></a>
```

Summary Section:

- Summary: Phishing attempt impersonating GMX via Google Sites which redirects to another site hosted on Netlify. Site taken down mid-investigation. No payload observed, but credential harvesting suspected.
- Impact: Medium – risk of stolen email or crypto credentials.
- Status: Escalated to Tier 2 for deeper investigation

Executive Incident Report

Case ID: 2025-09-10-001

Prepared by: Oluwaniyi Damilare Enoch

Date & Time: 2025-09-10, 11:00 – 13:00

Severity Level: Medium

Category: Phishing

Executive Summary

A suspicious URL (hxxps[:]sites[.]google[.]com/view/xksl/home) was identified and investigated. The site impersonated GMX, a popular brand (email provider and crypto exchange). Multiple URL reputation checks confirmed the site and its redirects as malicious (phishing).

The phishing chain redirected through a Google link to a Netlify page (wonderful-ganache-327ff8.netlify.app), which has since been taken offline. The intended purpose was likely credential harvesting.

Incident Details

Investigation Findings

- Initial URL: hxxps[:]sites[.]google[.]com/view/xksl/home
- Observed Behavior: Displayed GMX phishing page with “Click Here” button.
- Redirect Chain:
 - Google Sites → Google Redirect → Netlify hosted page
- Final Destination: Netlify site (offline at time of investigation).
- Reputation: All three URLs flagged as phishing on VirusTotal.
- MITRE ATT&CK Mapping: T1566.002 (Phishing via link)

Impact Assessment

- No active malware payload was observed.
- If live, users who clicked through may have exposed login credentials.
- Business risk: Compromise of email accounts could enable further phishing, business email compromise, or data leakage.
- Severity justification: Rated Medium due to limited exposure (site offline during analysis, no payload detected), though credential theft was the likely objective.

Recommendations

1. Block the identified URLs at the network level.
2. Alert users to be cautious of GMX-themed phishing attempts.
3. Monitor logs for any connections to the flagged Netlify domain and similar credential-harvesting campaigns.
4. Submit takedown requests for phishing pages if still active.

Conclusion

This was a confirmed phishing attempt leveraging Google Sites and Netlify as hosting platforms. The primary goal was likely credential theft targeting GMX users. Although the page is offline, the infrastructure indicates an active phishing campaign. Similar attempts may reappear, and proactive monitoring is recommended.